

Algebra First-Year Exam, May 2023, Part 2

Answer four problems. If you turn in more than four, only the first four will be graded. Within reason, you may use theorems as long as you state them clearly.

1. Show that the ring

$$\mathbb{Z}[\sqrt{-5}] = \{a + b\sqrt{-5} \mid a, b \in \mathbb{Z}\}$$

is not a unique factorization domain.

2. Which of the following rings are integral domains? Fields? Explain.

(i) $\mathbb{Q}[X, Y]/(X(X+1) + 2X^2Y - Y^3)$

(ii) $\mathbb{Q}[X, Y]/(X^2 - Y^2)$

(iii) $\mathbb{Z}[X, Y]/(2, X, Y - 1)$.

3. Let R be an integral domain. Recall that an R -module M has rank n if n is the largest integer such that M has n R -linearly independent elements. Show that an R -module M has rank n if and only if M has a submodule $N \subseteq M$ such that N is free of rank n , and M/N is torsion.

4. Let F be a field, M an extension of F and L, K two finite extensions of F contained in M . Show that if $[L : F]$ and $[K : F]$ are relatively prime, $L \cap K = F$.

5. This problem has two parts.

(i) List all irreducible polynomials in $\mathbb{F}_2[X]$ of degree at most three.

(ii) List representatives for each conjugacy class of the group $GL_3(\mathbb{F}_2)$.

6. Let F be a field, V an F -vector space of finite dimension and $T : V \rightarrow V$ a linear transformation. Show that if the minimal polynomial of T is irreducible of degree d then the dimension of V is a multiple of d .